Expressing surprise, she said, ‘Sardar Sahib, how can you imagine that I would commit such a mistake?’ She then became pensive, and said she knew that sooner or later she would be killed by Sikh militants. She was not worried about that but did not know what would happen to her children after her death. These were the same words she had spoken during her meeting at 1 Akbar Road in April 1984 with Kao and Nagrani, when she overruled the SFF commando operation. Perhaps it was her way of expressing her helplessness.

Incidentally, Swaran Singh met Indira Gandhi on or after 29 May, by when she had already given her approval to the revised plan as suggested by Lt Gen. Sundarji. However, Swaran Singh returned fully reassured, but remained so only till he witnessed the ferocity of the action taken, in the form of Operation Blue Star.

On 30 May, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi met President Zail Singh, who, by virtue of his position as Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Armed Forces, should have been taken into confidence, if not consulted, about the planned army operation at the Golden Temple. She spent over an hour discussing with him the new formula for reaching an agreement with the Akalis. [5] This option had already been closed on 29 May when the army was given the go-ahead to implement the revised plan for the operation. It meant that the person who had originally planned operation Bhindranwale-Khalistan (Op-1 and Op-2) for furthering the prospects of the Congress could no longer be trusted with a decision to use the army to flush out Bhindranwale and other extremists from the Golden Temple complex. Maybe she did not want to hear a ‘no’ from the Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Armed Forces for an army operation that she had already approved.

The Harmandir Sahib

The foundation stone of Harmandir Sahib, also known as Darbar Sahib, was laid in AD 1588, as per a personal request from the fifth Sikh Guru, Arjan Dev (AD 1563–1604), by a pious Muslim saint of his time, Mian Mir Mohammad of Lahore. The construction was completed in 1601. Meanwhile, the Adi Granth was compiled under